

DIYA REDDY KOUKUTLA

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EXPERIENCE

2025- PRESENT

Shrimp Improvement Systems Technician I

I support shrimp grow-out operations by preparing and maintaining tanks, assisting with transfers and harvesting, and managing materials and equipment. I perform daily tasks such as feeding, dissolved oxygen monitoring, and tank cleaning while following strict biosecurity and safety protocols. I also assist with pack-out preparations, handle deliveries, and help improve operational quality, safety, and inventory management.

2024 - PRESENT

Hawaii Pacific University - Oceanic Institute

UNDERGRADUATE RESEARCH ASSISTANT

I developed research and analytical skills while conducting the DNA barcoding of Lobster Phyllosoma Larvae Dispersal in the Hawaiian Archipelago. Other projects I focused on include the collection of dinoflagellates to look at Ciguatera Fish Poisoning across the island of Oahu, as well as the identification of different marine species in intertidal quadrats in Hawaii to look at percentage abundance using CoralNet.

ADDITIONAL PROJECTS

- Temperature preference of Abudedefduf, fish husbandry, and DNA barcoding to identify mutated fish using an annual temperature preference chamber with FastTrack.exe excel (Dr. Keith Korsmeyer, HPU)
- Research on Claudin Barriers on the Brink: How Conflicting Tissue and Cellular Priorities Drive IBD Pathogenesis (Dr. Christopher Capaldo, HPU)
- Presented research at the American Fisheries Society (AFS) Annual Meeting, 2025

EDUCATION

2022- 2025 • Hawaii Pacific University (HPU), Honolulu, USA

B.S in Marine Biology

2019-2021 • CHIREC International School, Hyderabad, India

High School Diploma

SKILLS

- English and Hindi (fluent)
- **Data analysis and Statistical Interpretation (R, Python)**
- Microscopy (light, fluorescence, and dissecting)
- **Cell management (feeding, splitting, counting)**
- Sample preparation and preservation (tissue, DNA, environmental samples)
- **Molecular biological techniques and bioinformatics (PCR, DNA sequencing, barcoding, genotyping -Geneious prime)**
- Sampling techniques (plankton tows, quadrat surveys, transects, CTD, Argo float)
- **Advanced marine organism identification (algae, invertebrates, vertebrates)**
- Networking & Presentation skills
- **Boat equipment handling and navigation (HPU RV Kaholo)**

CERTIFICATIONS

- **Scientific Diving [May 2025]**
- First Aid, CPR, AED, O2 Certification
- **Lab Safety Certified (CITI & NIH)**
- INBRE Intern [2024]